

Post-incident review PIR-2025-021

Order Management: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 16 November 2025, Order Management experienced partial outage in production (Southeast Asia) for about 25 minutes. The error-rate alert paged the on-call engineer. Investigation found that a certificate on the internal API gateway lapsed over a weekend.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw partial outage for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:20 First signal received.
- 09:33 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:54 Likely cause identified.
- 10:09 Mitigation applied.
- 10:43 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a certificate on the internal API gateway lapsed over a weekend.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Load test the service at twice the expected peak before the next campaign.
- Add a pre-deployment check that validates the setting against the production baseline.